

Ultimate camouflage

WWII saw the americans cover an entire air-force base in camouflage netting. A remarkable feat of engineering. <http://digit.in/1jtjnKV>

What you pointin' at?

Do you have an overwhelming urge to point at something? If you do, just head over to: <http://www.pointerpointer.com/>

Canon PowerShot G16

The much awaited upgrade to the G15

The Canon PowerShot G16 is the latest release from Canon in the advanced point and shoot category and is a long awaited update to one of our favourite cameras, the G15. There's not much new here, except for the sensor and a few changes here and there. It feels more like an incremental release rather than a major update, but it's still a pretty interesting little camera.

For starters, while Canon has maintained the 13.2MP resolution, the regular CMOS sensor has been upgraded to the BSI class. While the resolution has technically been bumped up, the effective resolution of the output images is still 12 megapixel because the remaining 1 megapixel is being used as phase detection pixels. The added phase detect pixels have led to the



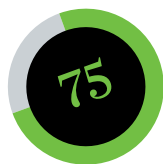
consistent with the performance of the G15 as well, seeing how the two cameras employ the same lens. Things take on a much different shade when shooting in low light though. We had expected that since the G16 rocked a BSI sensor, the low light performance would be noticeably different from that of its predecessor, but that turned out to not be the case.

We took a bunch of photos at ISO 3200 and noticed quite a few issues. Firstly, there was noticeable noise, but the good thing is that it wasn't the ugly red and blue dots. The noise we saw in our images was more of grain, which would have been okay if it was fine grain. The second issue we noticed was a strong drop in contrast coupled with a slight colour shift. The good thing, however, was that the colour shift could be recovered and contrast fixed, but what it does mean is that you're absolutely going to have to shoot RAW to make it all happen..

In terms of image quality, the G16 isn't leaps and bounds ahead of the G15, regardless of the BSI sensor. However, what has improved quite a bit is the focusing system, which in of itself is a pretty solid reason to buy this camera. While the IQ may not be much better than its predecessor, the G16's images are still incredibly good, coming from the tiny 1/1.7" sensor.

G16 being a very competent at auto focusing. We tested the camera in several lighting conditions, such as bright day light, night time, pitch dark, shooting at a high contrast target, shooting at a low contrast target etc and found that the only time the camera's focus system hit a snag was when shooting in very low contrast situations. This is when we were shooting with the camera in very little light, and while there was some contrast on the subject we were trying to get it to focus on, it just wasn't enough. faltering in this area is not surprising, as even most DSLRs struggle in such lighting conditions.

The image quality department threw up a few surprises. The camera comes with a BSI-CMOS sensor, which should ideally help the camera under low light conditions, etc. During our daylight test, the G16 did a splendid job with colour reproduction and contrast. Shooting in JPG mode (it can shoot RAW too). The images are incredibly sharp, something that's



Features80
Performance70
Value70
Design80

Specifications

Sensor: 1/1.7" 13 megapixel BSI-CMOS Sensor; **Lens:** 28-140mm f/1.8-2.8; **Shoots Raw:** Yes

Contact

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CM Storm Mizar

Is this the czar of gaming mice? Probably not.



Made for right handed gamers, the Mizar has an Avago 8200 DPI laser sensor. The design of the Mizar is pretty basic with no unnecessary modifications, making it a comfortable mouse to hold. The body is almost entirely made of plastic but the mouse has rubber strips on the sides for improving grip. The Mizar comes with seven programmable buttons. It tracked well in games without any hiccup but has no weight management option. Overall, the Mizar is a good gaming mouse but you may find better options, including the Roccat Kone Pure in this price range.



Features69
Build Quality73
Value for money65

Specifications

Switches used: Omron key switches; **Sensor:** Avago 9800 laser; **DPI:** 8200 DPI; **Polling Rate:** 1000Hz; **Onboard Memory:** 128kb; **Acceleration:** 30 g's; **Weight:** 121 grams; **Cable:** 1.8 metre braided; **Warranty:** 2 years

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